

PULSE: The Balanced Life

Complete Product Specification Document

This document provides a comprehensive technical and product specification for **PULSE: The Balanced Life** — a mobile wellness application designed to help users assess, track, and improve balance across the five core domains of a fulfilling life. From the initial assessment engine to the daily check-in system, scoring algorithms, screen blueprints, and database architecture, this specification covers everything needed to design, build, and launch the Minimum Viable Product (MVP).



Spirituality

Meaning & purpose



Family & Friends

Relationships & support



Work / Productivity

Career & responsibilities



Health

Physical & mental wellbeing



Financial

Stability & security

Product Overview & Vision

FOUNDATION

PULSE: The Balanced Life is a personal wellness application built on the principle that true wellbeing cannot be measured by a single metric. Most people optimize one area of life — career success, physical fitness, or financial wealth — while unknowingly neglecting others. Over time, this imbalance leads to burnout, loneliness, stress, and dissatisfaction, even when conventional success metrics appear strong.

PULSE addresses this by measuring life holistically across five interconnected domains. The app provides users with an objective starting score through a structured 25-question assessment, then maintains an evolving picture of their life balance through fast, daily check-ins that take no more than 60 seconds to complete. The result is a system that is both reflective and behavioral — it not only tells users where they stand but actively encourages small daily actions that compound into meaningful, lasting change.

The Core Problem

Traditional wellness apps focus on a single dimension — fitness, mindfulness, or budgeting — leaving users with an incomplete picture of their overall life balance. Success in one area can mask critical deficits in others.

The PULSE Solution

PULSE integrates all five life domains into a single unified score, visualizes imbalance clearly, and uses daily micro-habits to update scores dynamically — giving users a living, breathing map of their life.

Fast & Simple

Assessment in ~2 minutes. Daily check-in in 30–60 seconds.

Behavior-Focused

Scores update based on real daily actions, not just feelings.

Visually Powerful

The Balance Wheel gives instant insight into life distribution.

Motivating

Streaks, insights, and weekly progress keep users engaged.

The Starting Assessment

CORE FEATURE

The Starting Assessment is the entry point for every new PULSE user. It consists of **25 questions** divided equally across the five life domains — 5 questions per domain. Each question uses a five-point frequency or satisfaction scale, and the responses are converted into a standardized 0–10 domain score. The full assessment should take approximately **2 minutes** to complete.

The purpose of the assessment is to establish a reliable, data-driven baseline for each user's life balance. This baseline score becomes the starting point from which all future progress is measured. It also immediately surfaces the user's strongest domain and the domain that most needs attention, giving them a clear and motivating starting narrative for their PULSE journey.

Answer Score Conversion Table

Answer	Score	Interpretation
Never	0	This aspect is absent from daily life
Rarely	2.5	Occasional presence, needs significant attention
Sometimes	5.0	Moderate presence, room for meaningful improvement
Often	7.5	Healthy presence, minor refinement possible
Always	10.0	Fully integrated, a strength to maintain

Domain Score Formula

Each domain score is calculated by averaging the five question scores within that domain:

Domain Score = (Q1 + Q2 + Q3 + Q4 + Q5) ÷ 5

Result is expressed on a 0–10 scale, rounded to one decimal place.

Example Score Calculation

If a user's five responses within a domain convert to scores of 7.5, 5.0, 7.5, 5.0, and 5.0 respectively, the domain score is calculated as: (7.5 + 5 + 7.5 + 5 + 5) ÷ 5 = 30 ÷ 5 = **6.0 / 10**.

The Five Domains: Questions & Measures

ASSESSMENT CONTENT

Each of the five PULSE domains is precisely defined to measure a distinct dimension of life fulfillment. The questions within each domain are carefully designed to capture both frequency of behavior and subjective satisfaction, providing a nuanced and accurate picture of each area. Below is the complete question set for all five domains.

1	Spirituality <i>Measures: Purpose, meaning, inner peace</i> - How often do you feel your life has meaning or purpose? - How often do you reflect on your personal values or beliefs? - How often do you experience inner peace or calm? - How often do you engage in activities that nourish your spirit? - How aligned do you feel your daily actions are with your values?
2	Family & Friends <i>Measures: Relationship strength, social connection</i> - How satisfied are you with your relationships with family or close friends? - How often do you spend meaningful time with people important to you? - How supported do you feel by family or friends? - How comfortable are you sharing personal challenges with someone close? - How connected do you feel to the people who matter most in your life?
3	Work / Productivity <i>Measures: Work satisfaction and productivity</i> - How satisfied are you with your work, study, or daily responsibilities? - How motivated do you feel about your work or goals? - How manageable is your workload? - How productive do you feel most days? - How meaningful do you find your work or daily activities?
4	Health <i>Measures: Physical, mental, and emotional wellbeing</i> - How would you rate your overall physical health? - How often do you engage in physical activity or exercise? - How well do you manage stress in your daily life? - How well do you sleep most nights? - How would you rate your overall mental and emotional wellbeing?
5	Financial <i>Measures: Financial stability and security</i> - How secure do you feel about your current financial situation? - How well are you able to manage your expenses? - How confident are you about your future financial stability? - How often do financial worries cause you stress? - How satisfied are you with your ability to save or build financial security?

Scoring System: Balanced Life Score & True Balance

SCORING ENGINE

Calculating the Overall Balanced Life Score

Once all five domain scores are calculated, the **Balanced Life Score** is computed as the simple arithmetic mean of all five domain scores. This produces a single, unified score on a 0–10 scale that represents the user's overall life balance at a given moment in time.

Balanced Life Score = (Spirituality + Family & Friends + Work + Health + Financial) ÷ 5

Example Calculation

Domain	Score	Status
Spirituality	6.0	Moderate
Family & Friends	7.0	Strong ★
Work / Productivity	5.5	Needs attention
Health	6.0	Moderate
Financial	4.5	Needs attention ⚠
Balanced Life Score	5.8 / 10	Starting baseline

Calculation: (6.0 + 7.0 + 5.5 + 6.0 + 4.5) = 29.0 ÷ 5 = **5.8 / 10**

Measuring True Balance (Imbalance Detection)

The Balanced Life Score alone is not sufficient to fully characterize a user's wellbeing. A user with scores of 9, 9, 9, 3, and 3 would receive the same average as a user with scores of 6.6 across all domains — yet these represent profoundly different life situations. To address this, PULSE also measures the **spread** between the highest and lowest domain scores.

Imbalance Indicator Formula

Imbalance Gap = Highest Domain Score – Lowest Domain Score

- Gap of 0–2: Well balanced across all areas
- Gap of 2–3.5: Moderate imbalance, worth monitoring
- Gap of 3.5+: Significant imbalance — requires highlighted attention

Warning Example

Spirituality: 8 | Family: 8 | Work: 9 | Health: 4 | Financial: 3

Average = 6.4 — appears healthy, but gap = 6 points. This person is critically imbalanced despite a moderate overall score.

The app must highlight strong domains with positive reinforcement and flag weak domains with actionable suggestions. Visual representation through the Balance Wheel is critical for making this imbalance immediately intuitive and understandable for users.

The Daily Check-In System

CORE ENGAGEMENT FEATURE

The Daily Check-In is the heartbeat of the PULSE app. While the Starting Assessment establishes a baseline, it is the daily check-in system that keeps the app alive, dynamic, and genuinely useful over time. Think of the relationship this way: the assessment is the starting point; the daily check-ins are the continuous measurement engine that reflects how a user's life actually evolves day by day.

The system is intentionally designed for speed and simplicity. Requiring no more than **30–60 seconds** to complete, the daily check-in asks one binary-style question per domain — five questions total. This brevity is a strategic design decision: most wellness apps fail because they ask too much and users abandon them. PULSE's micro-check-in format prioritizes **completion rate over depth**, understanding that consistent shallow data dramatically outperforms occasional deep data for behavioral tracking purposes.

The Five Daily Questions

- Spirituality

Did you do something today that connected you to your values or sense of purpose?
- Family & Friends

Did you connect with family or friends today?
- Work / Productivity

Did you make meaningful progress in your work or responsibilities today?
- Health

Did you take care of your physical or mental health today? (e.g., exercise, rest, stress management)
- Financial

Did you make a positive financial decision today? (e.g., saving money, avoiding unnecessary spending, managing bills)

Daily Scoring & Options

Answer	Points	Meaning
No	0	No relevant action taken today
A little	1	Partial or minor action taken
Yes	2	Full intentional action taken

☐

Maximum daily score: 5 domains × 2 points = 10 points per day

Daily Score Calculation & Rolling Average

SCORING LOGIC

The daily check-in system uses a **rolling 7-day average** to update each domain score dynamically. This approach smooths out single bad days or single exceptional days, producing a score that genuinely reflects a user's recent behavioral patterns rather than a single moment in time. Each day's check-in data replaces the oldest day in the rolling window, keeping the score continuously current and responsive.

Rolling 7-Day Average Formula

Domain Score = (Sum of daily points over 7 days ÷ 14) × 10

The denominator is 14 because the maximum possible score over 7 days is 7 days × 2 points = 14 points.

Example: Health Domain — One Full Week

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
2	1	2	0	2	1	2

Total: 2 + 1 + 2 + 0 + 2 + 1 + 2 = **10 points**
Health Score: (10 ÷ 14) × 10 = **7.1 / 10**

Updated Balance Score Example

Domain	Updated Score	Change
Spirituality	6.5	+0.5
Family & Friends	7.0	+0.0
Work / Productivity	5.8	+0.3
Health	7.1	+1.1
Financial	5.0	+0.5
Balanced Life Score	6.3 / 10	+0.5

Score Progression Over Time



This chart illustrates the typical growth trajectory for an engaged PULSE user over a 30-day period. Consistent daily check-ins, even with modest "A little" responses, produce compounding positive movement in the overall Balance Score — reinforcing the core product message that small daily actions create long-term life balance.

Engagement Mechanics

RETENTION & MOTIVATION

Sustained user engagement is the most critical challenge for any behavior-change app. PULSE employs a layered engagement strategy designed to build intrinsic motivation through visible progress, social accountability through streaks, and surprise delight through smart insights. Each mechanism is designed to reinforce the core habit loop: **trigger → check-in → reward → repeat**.



Push Notification

The app sends one daily notification: *"Take 30 seconds to check in and keep your life in balance."* Users tap to open directly to the check-in screen. Timing can be customized in settings.



Daily Streak System

Users build a consecutive-day streak with every completed check-in. Missing a single day resets the streak to zero. Research consistently shows streak mechanics dramatically increase daily retention in habit-forming apps.



Smart Insights

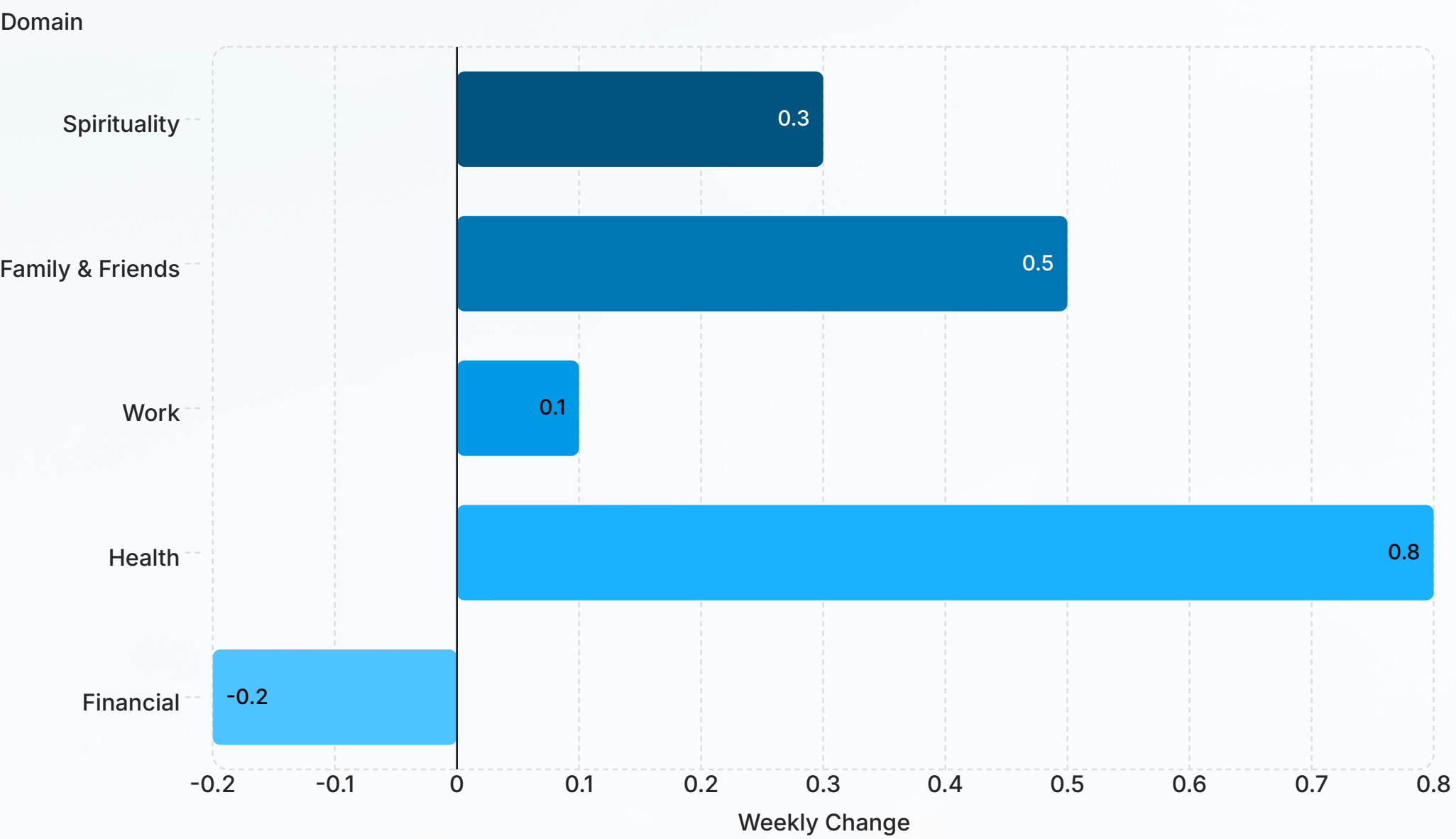
After each check-in, the app delivers a personalized AI-style insight. Example: *"Your Health score improved this week. Small actions like exercise and sleep are helping your overall balance."*



Weekly Balance Update

Every Sunday, users receive a weekly summary showing the change in each domain score. Positive changes appear in green; declines prompt encouraging suggestions rather than negative framing.

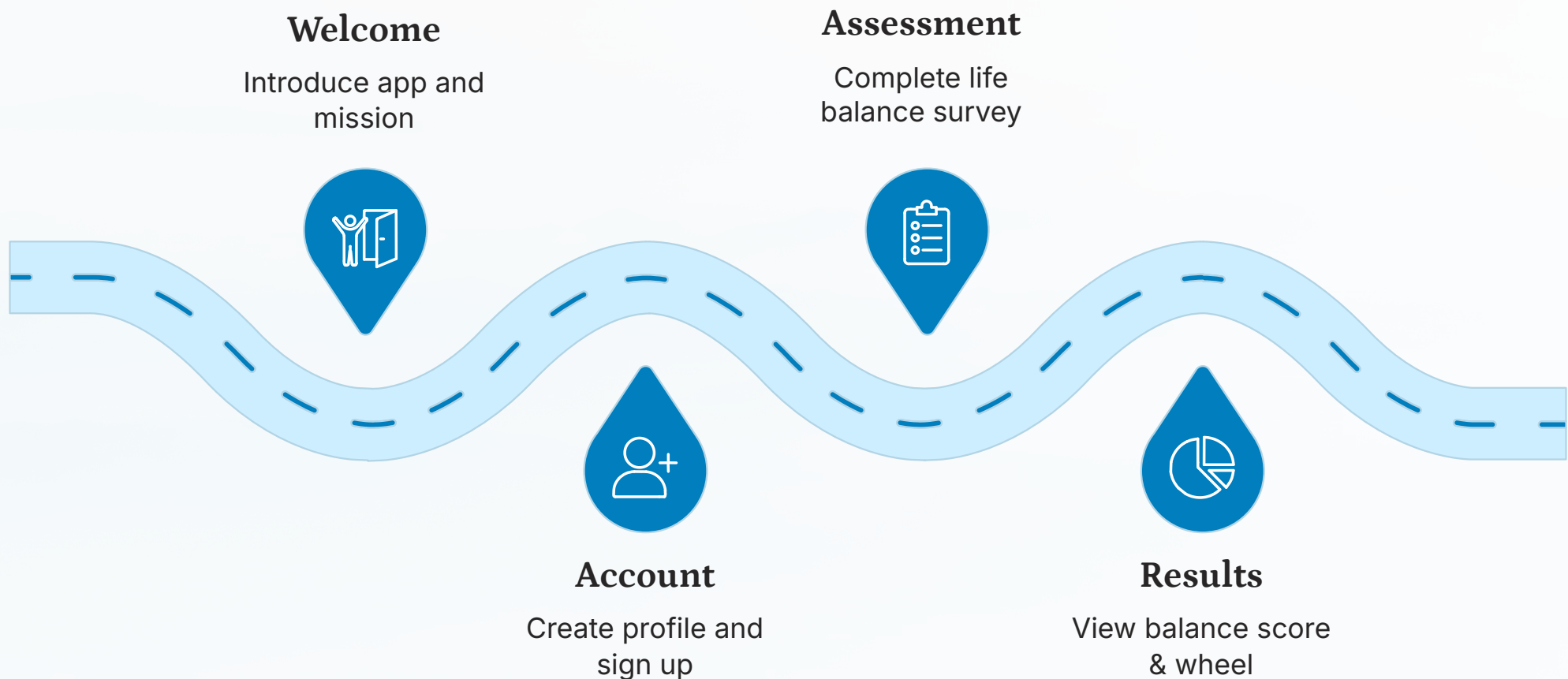
Weekly Domain Progress Example



Complete Screen Blueprint

UX SPECIFICATION

The following section provides a complete screen-by-screen blueprint for the PULSE MVP. Each screen description includes its primary purpose, key UI components, and functional requirements. This blueprint is intended to guide frontend development and serves as the reference for all design and engineering decisions relating to the user interface.



This flow represents the complete user journey through the PULSE app. New users move through onboarding and assessment before landing on the dashboard, which becomes their daily home. The daily check-in loop — from notification to insight — is the core retention engine of the product. Returning users bypass the assessment entirely and go straight to their dashboard.

Screen 1–3: Onboarding Flow

SCREEN SPECIFICATIONS

1

Welcome Screen

Purpose: Introduce the app and communicate the value proposition immediately.

Content: App logo and name (BALANCED LIFE / PULSE), tagline: *"Find balance across the five areas that shape your life,"* the five domain labels (Spirituality, Family & Friends, Work, Health, Financial), a prominent **Start** CTA button.

Design notes: Full-screen hero layout. Clean, calm aesthetic. Minimal text. The five domain labels should be visually arranged in a circular or balanced layout to preview the Balance Wheel concept.

2

Account Creation Screen

Purpose: Capture user credentials to enable data persistence and progress tracking.

Fields: Name (text input), Email (email input with validation), Password (masked input with strength indicator). CTA: **Create Account** (primary) and **Log In** (secondary link for returning users).

Backend action: Creates user record in database. Generates unique user_id. Initializes empty domain score records.

3

Assessment Intro Screen

Purpose: Set expectations before the 25-question assessment begins.

Content: Title: *"Life Balance Assessment,"* description: *"Answer a few questions to calculate your starting balance score. This takes about 2 minutes,"* prominent **Start Assessment** CTA.

Design notes: This screen reduces drop-off by making the time commitment explicit and manageable. Consider a subtle animation of the Balance Wheel to create anticipation.

Screen 4–6: Assessment & Results

SCREEN SPECIFICATIONS

Screen 4: Assessment Questions

Displays one question at a time with the domain label clearly shown above. Answer options: Never / Rarely / Sometimes / Often / Always (tappable buttons or segmented control). Required UI elements: progress bar (e.g., "Question 3 of 25"), back/next navigation buttons, domain section header to orient the user. Scores are stored locally as the user progresses and submitted on completion.

Screen 5: Balance Score Result

Displays immediately after the 25th question is submitted. Shows each domain score (0–10), the overall Balanced Life Score prominently, clearly labeled "Strongest Area" and "Needs Attention" badges. Example: Overall Score 5.8/10, Strongest: Family & Friends (7.0), Needs Attention: Financial (4.5). This screen must be celebratory and motivating — not clinical.

Screen 6: Balance Wheel

The most visually powerful screen in the app. Displays a spider/radar chart or segmented circle with five axes representing each domain. Each axis is filled proportionally to the domain score (0–10). Large gaps between domains are visually obvious and immediately intuitive. Users can tap a domain segment to see its score and a brief description. This screen should feel like a revelation — users instantly understand their life balance at a glance.

Screen 7–9: Core Daily Screens

SCREEN SPECIFICATIONS

Screen 7: Main Dashboard

The primary home screen. Seen every day by active users. Must display: Current Balance Score (large, prominent), all five domain scores with visual indicators, a **Daily Check-In** CTA button (most important action), a **View Progress** secondary button, and current streak count. The dashboard should feel like a personal cockpit — comprehensive but clean. Domain scores should use color coding: green (7+), amber (4–6.9), red (below 4).

Screen 8: Daily Check-In

The most-used screen in the app. Five questions, one per domain, each with three answer options: No / A little / Yes. Questions should appear sequentially or on a single scrollable screen. A **Submit** button appears after all five are answered. The UI must be frictionless — large tap targets, minimal scrolling, clear visual confirmation on selection. Progress indicator showing "3 of 5 answered" helps users complete without abandoning.

Screen 9: Daily Insight

Immediate reward after check-in submission. Displays: congratulatory message, a personalized insight based on recent score changes, current streak count with visual emphasis. Example: *"Great job checking in! Your Health score improved today. Small daily actions create long-term balance. Check-in streak: 5 days 🔥"*. This screen is the emotional payoff — it must feel rewarding and personal.

Screen 10–12: Progress & Settings

SCREEN SPECIFICATIONS



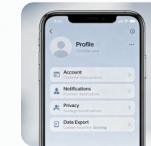
Screen 10: Progress Screen

Displays the Balance Score over time as a line chart (Week 1 through current week). Includes a **View Domain Progress** button to drill down into individual domain trends. Shows weekly balance update summary. The visual upward trend in the chart is the primary motivational hook — users must be able to see their growth at a glance. Chart should default to 4-week view with options to expand to 12 weeks.



Screen 11: Domain Detail Screen

Accessible by tapping any domain on the dashboard or progress screen. Displays: domain name and current score, recent activity log (e.g., Mon: saved money, Tue: avoided spending, Wed: overspent), trend chart for that domain specifically, and a personalized **Suggestion** — a short, actionable recommendation. Example: *"Try setting a small daily saving goal."* This is the deepest layer of insight in the MVP.



Screen 12: Profile & Settings

Basic account management: display name and email, notification toggle for Daily Check-In Reminder with customizable time, data export option (CSV of all check-in history), privacy policy link, and log out button. Settings should be minimal in MVP — complexity here is a distraction from the core product loop. Future versions may add social features, themes, and integration with health platforms.

Database Architecture

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

The PULSE backend requires a well-structured database to support user management, assessment storage, daily check-in recording, and score history. The following tables represent the minimum viable database schema required to support all MVP features. The recommended platform for MVP is **Firebase Firestore** (NoSQL) due to its real-time update capabilities and ease of integration with React Native and Flutter frontends.

Core Database Tables

Users Table Fields: user_id (primary key, auto-generated), name (string), email (string, unique), password_hash (string), created_at (timestamp), last_active (timestamp) Purpose: Core user identity and authentication record. Links to all other tables via user_id.	Assessments Table Fields: assessment_id, user_id (foreign key), completed_at (timestamp), spirituality_score (float), family_score (float), work_score (float), health_score (float), financial_score (float), balance_score (float) Purpose: Stores the result of the initial 25-question assessment and any future re-assessments. One record per assessment event per user.
Daily Check-ins Table Fields: checkin_id, user_id (foreign key), date (date), spirituality_score (int: 0/1/2), family_score (int: 0/1/2), work_score (int: 0/1/2), health_score (int: 0/1/2), financial_score (int: 0/1/2), total_points (int: 0–10), created_at (timestamp) Purpose: Primary daily data record. One row per user per day. Enforces one check-in per calendar day per user_id.	Balance Score History Table Fields: history_id, user_id (foreign key), week_start_date (date), spirituality_avg (float), family_avg (float), work_avg (float), health_avg (float), financial_avg (float), balance_score (float), streak_count (int) Purpose: Aggregated weekly snapshot used for the Progress Screen charts and weekly summary notifications. Computed from the Daily Check-ins table each Sunday.

Example Daily Check-In Record

user_id	date	spirituality	family	work	health	financial
user_245	2026-03-09	2	1	2	1	0

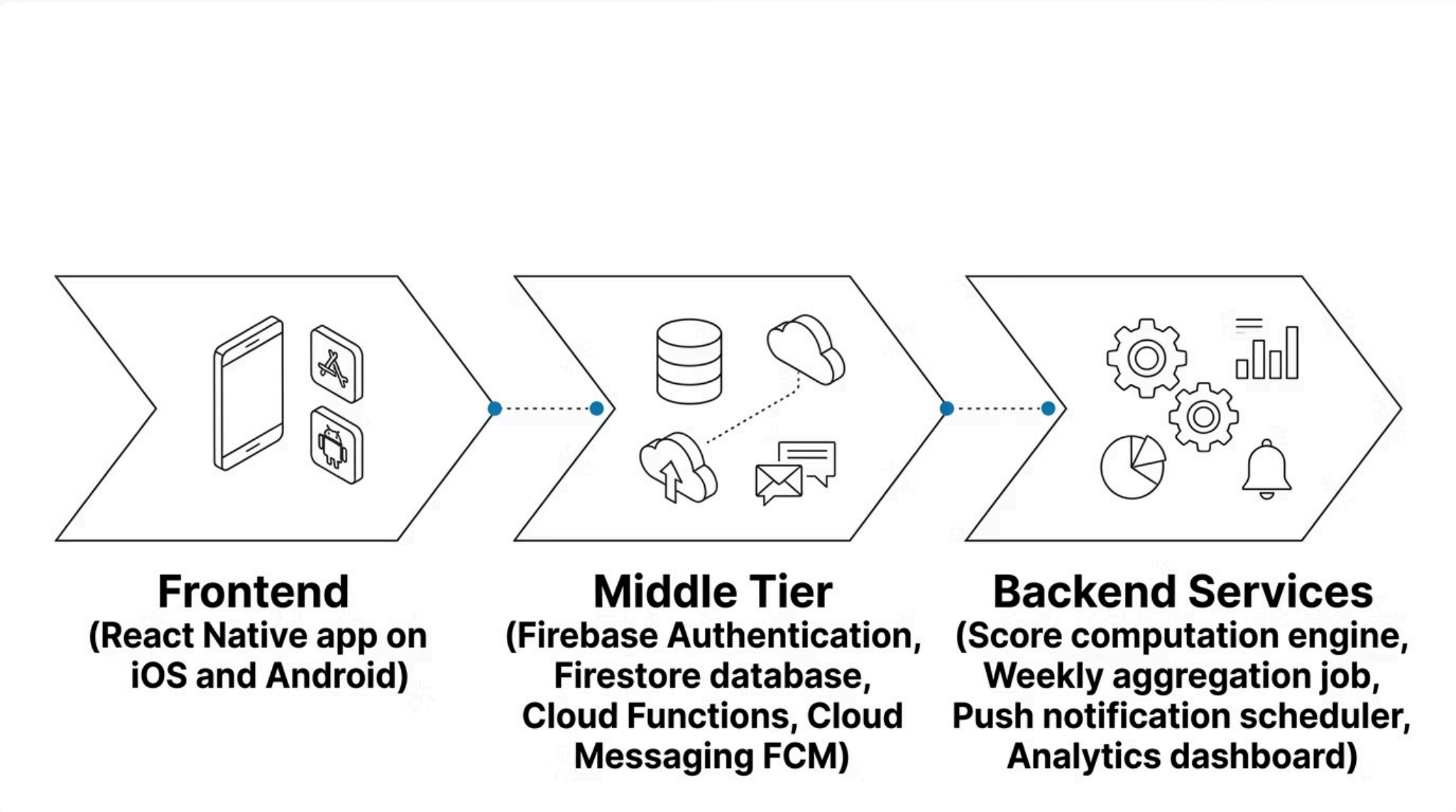
Technology Stack & Architecture

ENGINEERING SPECIFICATION

The PULSE MVP technology stack has been selected to optimize for **speed of development, cross-platform compatibility, and scalability**. The recommended stack allows a small team of 2–3 developers to build and ship the complete MVP within 8–12 weeks while maintaining the ability to scale to thousands of users without significant architectural changes.

Frontend — React Native Single codebase for both iOS and Android. Large community, extensive UI libraries, strong support for charting (Victory Native, React Native Charts). Alternative: Flutter (Dart) — excellent UI performance, growing ecosystem. Recommended for teams comfortable with Dart.	Backend — Firebase Firebase Authentication for user management. Firestore (NoSQL) for real-time data storage. Firebase Cloud Functions for server-side score computation and weekly aggregation jobs. Firebase Cloud Messaging (FCM) for push notifications. Firebase Analytics for user behavior tracking.	Visualization Radar/Spider Chart for the Balance Wheel (D3.js or Victory Native). Line charts for progress tracking. Bar charts for weekly domain summaries. All charts must be responsive, animated on load, and interactive (tap to see values). Consistent color palette: domain colors mapped to the five PULSE brand colors.
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System Architecture Overview



MVP Scope & Deliverables

PROJECT SCOPE

The Minimum Viable Product for PULSE is scoped to deliver the complete core user experience — from onboarding and assessment through to daily check-ins and progress tracking — without additional features that would extend development time unnecessarily. The MVP must prove the core hypothesis: that users will engage daily with a holistic life-balance tracking tool when the interface is fast, visual, and personally meaningful.

MVP Must-Have Features

- 1

User Account Creation & Authentication
Secure account creation with email/password. User data persisted across sessions and devices. Basic profile management in the settings screen.
- 2

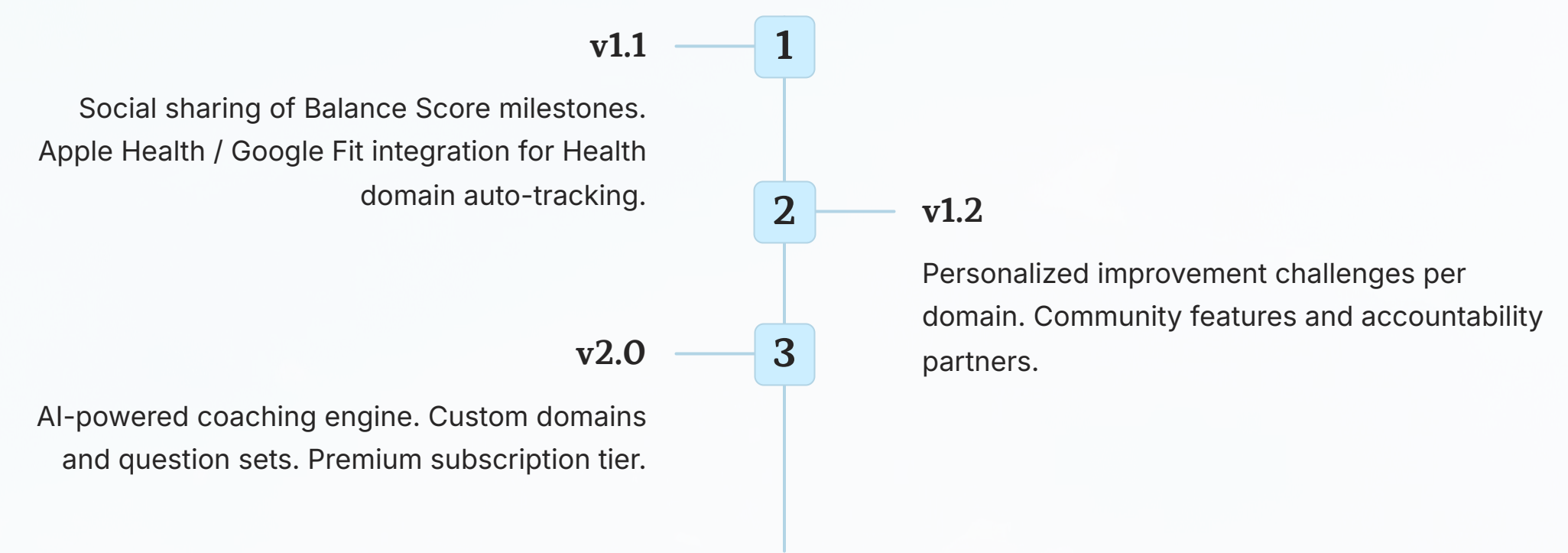
25-Question Life Balance Assessment
Full 5-domain, 5-question-per-domain assessment with progress indicator. Automatic score calculation and domain scoring. Results screen with Balance Score, strongest area, and needs-attention flag.
- 3

Balance Wheel Visualization
Interactive radar/spider chart showing all five domain scores. Immediate visual representation of life balance and imbalance gaps. Accessible from both results screen and dashboard.
- 4

Daily Check-In with Push Notifications
One daily check-in with five questions (one per domain). Push notification trigger via Firebase Cloud Messaging. Streak counter and daily insight after submission.
- 5

Progress Tracking & Weekly Summary
Balance Score line chart over time (week-by-week). Domain detail screens with activity log and suggestions. Weekly progress notification with domain-by-domain changes.

Post-MVP Feature Roadmap (Future Versions)



Why PULSE Will Work

PRODUCT PHILOSOPHY

The wellness app market is crowded — but most apps fail for the same reasons: they are too complex, too time-consuming, too narrow in focus, or too clinical in feel. PULSE is designed from the ground up to avoid every one of these failure modes.

Fast

The daily check-in takes 30–60 seconds. There is no excuse not to complete it, which is the most powerful design decision in the product.

Simple

Three answer options per question. Five questions per day. One score. One wheel. Simplicity is not a limitation — it is the product's greatest strength.

Behavioral

Scores update based on what users actually do each day, not just how they feel. This creates a virtuous cycle: good behavior improves scores, which motivates more good behavior.

Motivating

Streaks, weekly progress updates, personalized insights, and the visual satisfaction of watching the Balance Wheel expand — every feature is designed to make users want to come back tomorrow.

Holistic

By measuring all five life domains together, PULSE reveals truths that no single-focus app ever could. A user crushing it at work but neglecting health and relationships will see that imbalance clearly — and be empowered to change it.

"Assessment = starting point. Daily check-ins = continuous measurement. Together, they create a living map of a balanced life — one small action at a time."